

YASMINE BASSIL, PHD

NEUROSCIENTIST | RESEARCH LEADER

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Atlanta, GA | Open to Relocation

[website](#) | [linkedin](#)

SUMMARY

Neuroscientist and research leader with a record of building research and leadership infrastructure, leading cross-functional teams, and driving rigorous, reproducible science across complex, multi-stage projects. Built an independent research program from the ground up — securing \$260K+ in competitive funding, mentoring 15+ trainees, and carrying projects from data pipelines to 7 peer-reviewed publications — and translated technical work into durable institutional tools and lasting scientific relationships.

*Seeking **leadership and systems-building roles in neuroscience research**, with a preferred focus on expanding international scientific collaborations.*

SKILLS (selected)

leadership

cross-functional team leadership

program development

systems building

mentorship

research

statistical modeling & data analysis

competitive funding (\$260K+)

science communication

technical

python, bash/zsh, git, R

data visualization

reproducible pipelines

AI-agent orchestration

AI tools

Claude / Claude Code

Perplexity

LANGUAGES

English (fluent), Arabic (fluent), French (intermediate)

EXPERIENCE (selected)

NEUROSCIENCE PHD RESEARCHER

Aug 2020 – Jun 2026

Neural Plasticity Research Lab, Emory University

Research Leadership & Execution:

- Designed and led an independent research program investigating aging effects on spatial cognition. Recruited and managed 110+ participants, secured \$260K in competitive funding (NSF GRFP, NIH T32), and culminated in a dissertation defense and 7 peer-reviewed publications.
- Directed 15+ member Navigation Team, establishing meeting cadences, tracking milestones, and overseeing independent sub-studies per team member.

Technical Infrastructure & Tools:

- Established novel neuroimaging methodology (concurrent TMS-fMRI) as a shared institutional capability at Emory, expanding research access for the broader Atlanta scientific community.
- Built and open-sourced a city-scale VR environment in Unity (NavCity) and co-developed a custom neuroimaging pipeline (MR.Flow), replacing manual workflows with reproducible tools.
- Established lab-wide GitHub infrastructure (7 repositories) and standardized analysis pipelines.
- Created agentic workflows with Claude Code across the full research lifecycle — MR.Flow development, statistical analyses, figure generation, literature review — to standardize, automate, and reproduce complex multi-stage workflows and shipping 7+ open-source tools with Git repos.

CO-PRESIDENT

Jun 2023 – Jun 2025

Graduates in Neuroscience, Emory University

- Served as primary liaison between 120+ PhD students and program leadership, leading a 22-member executive board across 12 positions and organizing 10+ annual program events.
- Rebuilt organizational infrastructure from the ground up — establishing the first internal documentation system, defining officer roles, formalizing transition protocols, implementing meeting schedules, establishing recognition initiatives, and creating budget infrastructure — all designed to outlast any single leadership team.

CO-CHAIR

Jun 2021 – Jun 2023

Diversity, Equity, & Inclusion Committee, Emory Neuroscience Graduate Program

- Co-led a 17-member DEI committee across 3 subcommittees, serving as institutional liaison between students, faculty, and Laney Graduate School administration.
- Drove measurable program-level changes: conducted admissions review to identify and reduce bias, revised curriculum modules for neurological inclusivity, and partnered with Emory's DEI office to launch a new unconscious bias certificate training program adopted program-wide.

ORGANIZING COMMITTEE CHAIR Jul 2019 – Dec 2019

Brainhack ATL 2019

- Directed a 13-member interdisciplinary committee across multiple Atlanta institutions to design and execute a novel 3-day computational neuroscience hackathon.
- Secured \$35,000 in sponsorships, built 3 project tracks, recruited 6 faculty speakers, and drew 90+ applications from 9 institutions, selecting 30 attendees.

STEM COMMUNICATIONS FELLOW May 2019 – Aug 2020

College of Sciences, Georgia Institute of Technology

- Produced 164+ pieces of public-facing science communication across all 6 College of Sciences schools — written articles, graphics, social media posts, photography, video, and campus signage.
- Wrote, shot, and edited original coverage of faculty and student research and ran the College's social and news channels, translating technical work into narratives for general audiences.

PRESIDENT May 2017 – May 2020

Undergraduate Research Ambassadors, Georgia Institute of Technology

- Established the full operational structure of a 22-member undergraduate research organization, building committee structure across 4 functional areas (Events, Campus Relations, Outreach, Advertising).
- Grew program reach to 1,000+ students per semester through research fairs, workshops, panels, and office hours connecting undergraduates to research opportunities.

MENTORSHIP & TEACHING (selected)

- Directly mentored **15+** trainees (high school, undergraduate, and doctoral students), who produced: **5** award-winning presentations, **2** Highest Honors theses (Emory University), **2** Research Option Certificates with published theses (Georgia Tech), and secured **5** competitive fellowships (incl. Fulbright, DAAD-RISE).
- Taught **4** academic courses across Emory University and Georgia Tech, including: Instructor of Record (Explore Neuroscience & Behavioral Biology), Co-Instructor (Neurobiology Simulation & Analysis Lab), Program & Teaching Assistant (Global Neuro & Behavior), and Teaching Assistant (Principles of Motor Learning).

ADDITIONAL SERVICE & LEADERSHIP (selected)

Secretary & Editor-in-Chief (*The Central Sulcus*), Graduates in Neuroscience, Emory · Founder, International Student Task Force, Georgia Tech · Student Ambassador, College of Sciences, Georgia Tech

EDUCATION

PhD in Neuroscience — Emory University Aug 2020 – Jun 2026

Thesis: Behavioral and neural mechanisms of aging-related spatial navigation deficits.

BS in Neuroscience — Georgia Institute of Technology Aug 2016 – May 2020

Highest Honors · Zell Miller Scholarship · Psychology Minor · Research Option with Published Thesis.

GRANTS & FUNDING (selected)

NSF Graduate Research Fellowship (\$170K+, 2022–2025) · **NIH T32** Integrative Neuroscience Training Grant (\$90K+, 2021–2022) · **WISH Conference Grant** (\$1K, 2023)

PUBLICATIONS, PRESENTATIONS, & PRESS (selected)

- **7** peer-reviewed publications (incl. first-author work in *Frontiers in Aging Neuroscience* and *Neuropsychologia*, plus the *Nature Protocols* consensus paper) with **270+ citations (h-index 5)**, **12** self-presented conference presentations (incl. **1** platform presentation), and **2** presentation awards.
- **17** invited talks, including: Speaker, Atlanta Science Festival Tech Talks (2022); Keynote Speaker, Georgia Tech Neuroscience Research Symposium (2021).

HONORS & AWARDS (selected)

Emory Neuroscience Scientific Achievement Award (2026) · Emory Neuroscience Teaching Award (2025) · Emory Neuroscience Leadership Award (2024) · Emory Neuroscience Excellence in Mentorship Award (2023) — each awarded by faculty committee from 120+ students · Trainee Professional Development Award, Society for Neuroscience (2024) · Scholar, Georgia Tech / Emory Computational Neural Engineering Training Program (2021) · Inaugural Cohort, AEJMC ComSHER Division & Inclusive SciComm (2021)